Business case

Customer value, pricing tests, and illustrative first-year economics

Prepared 27 October 2026 · All amounts are illustrative USD assumptions, not market quotes or a forecast.

What this document says

DrillLoop is a proposed workspace for people who collect and review emergency exercise evidence. The likely user is an evaluator or preparedness lead. A possible buyer is a preparedness director. Hospitals are a starting customer hypothesis; municipal teams, airports, civil defense, training providers, and infrastructure operators are also candidates. No customer demand or willingness to pay has been confirmed.

What the product might add

Established platforms already offer after-action reports and corrective-action tracking. DrillLoop will test whether it is easier to open the exact source record behind a proposed finding, see uncertainty, record a reviewer decision, and later check completion evidence. This is a hypothesis to validate, not a claim that those features are unique.

Possible packages and price probes

Offer	Illustrative price	What to test
Per-exercise workspace	$1,500 / exercise	Budget and evaluator count for a single exercise.
Annual organization plan	$18,000 / year	Up to 12 exercises; test reviewer roles, support, and exports.
Private deployment	$65,000 / year	Higher security, onboarding, integration, and support needs.
Custom exercise template	$6,000 once	Time and expertise needed to map objectives and criteria.
Evaluator support services	$1,500 / day	Demand for setup, facilitation, or training.

Illustrative first-year scenarios

Annual plans include up to 12 exercises. Single-exercise counts below represent customers outside those plans. The figures are examples for planning, not a forecast.

Case	Assumed sales volume	Revenue	Costs*	After costs*
Conservative	6 annual plans; 20 single exercises; 4 templates; 10 service days	$177,000	$385,000	–$208,000
Base	15 annual; 40 single; 1 private; 8 templates; 30 days	$488,000	$645,000	–$157,000
High scale	50 annual; 150 single; 8 private; 30 templates; 150 days	$2,050,000	$1,870,000	+$180,000

*Costs are simplified staffing plus other operating costs. ‘After costs’ means revenue minus those costs; it is not net profit and excludes tax, financing, and cash timing.

Base case, worked through

15 annual plans × $18,000 = $270,000; 40 single exercises × $1,500 = $60,000; one private deployment = $65,000; eight templates = $48,000; and 30 support days = $45,000. Together these assumptions produce $488,000 of revenue.

The assumed costs are three full-time technical/product staff ($390,000), half of a full-time exercise expert ($70,000), and $185,000 for other costs. Total assumed cost is $645,000, so the example ends $157,000 below revenue.

How staffing costs were estimated

FTE means full-time equivalent: one person working full-time for a year. SME means subject-matter expert. Technical/product pay is assumed at $130,000 per FTE in the first two cases and $140,000 at high scale. Exercise expertise is assumed at $140,000–$150,000 per FTE. ‘Other’ costs ($90,000 / $185,000 / $600,000) cover hosting, security, legal, insurance, travel, customer support, and sales. These are planning assumptions, not salary or vendor quotes.

A simple time-value example

Suppose an evaluator currently spends 20 hours writing up one exercise and the product eventually reduces that work by 40%. That would free 8 hours per exercise. At 12 exercises a year, that is 96 hours. At an assumed loaded labor cost of $65 per hour, those hours represent $6,240 of staff capacity. Capacity means time available for other work; it is not cash savings unless paid hours, overtime, or staffing costs actually fall. This time-only example is below the proposed $18,000 annual price.

How to test the business case

Question	Evidence to collect in a pilot
Who owns the problem and budget?	Interview evaluators, preparedness leads, action owners, and buyers at 2–3 organizations.
Does traceability reduce work?	Time evidence lookup and reviewer corrections on comparable exercises.
Replace or integrate with existing tools?	Map current HSEEP, Veoci, D4H, and document workflows; test export needs.
Can customers deploy it safely?	Confirm data rules, identity, retention, access logs, and hosting requirements.
Will they pay?	Test per-exercise, annual, and private-deployment prices; record actual procurement and support costs.

Main risks

Existing tools may already solve the problem; procurement can take time; private hosting and custom templates may be expensive to support; evidence may be sensitive; evaluators may not trust AI suggestions; and the current rule set may not work on new scenarios. The pilot should test source support, reviewer edits, action ownership, independent closure checks, and actual operating costs.

Research context

[1] FEMA, Homeland Security Exercise and Evaluation Program Doctrine, January 2020: https://www.fema.gov/sites/default/files/2020-04/Homeland-Security-Exercise-and-Evaluation-Program-Doctrine-2020-Revision-2-2-25.pdf

[2] FEMA Preparedness Toolkit, Exercise Evaluation: https://preptoolkit.fema.gov/web/training/evaluation

[3] California Department of Public Health, Power Loss scenario and hospital objectives: https://www.cdph.ca.gov/Programs/EPO/Pages/swmhe_scenarios_power_loss.aspx

[4] Veoci, After-action reporting product page: https://veoci.com/emergency-management/after-action-reporting/

[5] D4H, Emergency response team readiness software: https://www.d4h.com/team-readiness-software

[6] Mid-South Emergency Planning Coalition, 2023 Full Scale Exercise AAR/IP example: https://midsouthepc.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/03/Mid-South-HCC-2023-Non-Hospital-FSE-AAR.pdf